Non-Proliferation Treaty (NPT). India's consistent position—defended passionately by virtually all politicians and intellectuals—has been that it will happily renounce nuclear weapons when all the other nuclear-armed states also do so, but that until that comes to pass, it asserts its right to acquire them for defensive purposes (initially vis-à-vis China, but more recently with respect to Pakistan).[207] More recently, India also has suffered indirectly from U.S. financial sanctions on Iran, related to U.S. objections to what Iran claims is its development of civilian nuclear energy technology rather than weaponry. India receives around 60 percent of its petroleum imports from Iran and normally pays by using the SWIFT international clearing system. The U.S. exclusion of Iran from the SWIFT network generates additional expense and inconvenience for India.[208]

Second, as a general principle, India's leaders resist Western efforts to promote regime change abroad through the use of force, which they view as illegitimate. In fact, the majority elite opinion in India views U.S. foreign policy in the post–Cold War era as unnecessarily aggressive. Indian politicians are sovereignty hawks[209] and are reflexively opposed to foreign policy carried out by means of financial sanctions. In common with its fellow BRICS, India thus resists on principle international efforts since 2012 to replace Syrian President Bashar al-Assad. Given this background, it is unsurprising that Indian officials have supported Russia's objections to Western financial sanctions to punish Russian operations in Ukraine.

Third, although India has long possessed ideas for global financial governance reforms, its experts are not routinely consulted. For example, in 2010, then–British Prime Minister Gordon Brown proposed to the G20 that the major economies of the world institute a tax on cross-border financial transactions (which he labeled a "Tobin tax," after a somewhat similar proposal made by economist James Tobin decades earlier), and employ the funds to increase IMF resources, strained by current and projected lending to comparatively wealthy European countries hit by the global financial crisis. This might have gone forward were it not for strenuous objections from emerging economies such as India, which flatly opposed this proposal due to the use to which the funds collected would be put. Finance Minister Pranab Mukerjee observed that India would prefer to employ its scarce financial resources for extending to banking services India's own "tens of millions of unbanked."[210] Writing in his personal capacity in 2014 in the